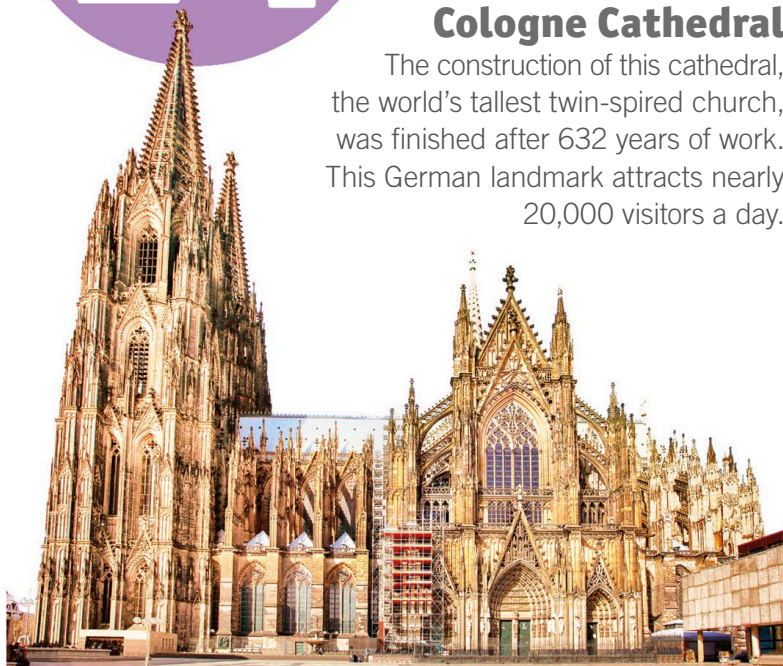


August

14



1880

Cologne Cathedral

The construction of this cathedral, the world's tallest twin-spired church, was finished after 632 years of work. This German landmark attracts nearly 20,000 visitors a day.

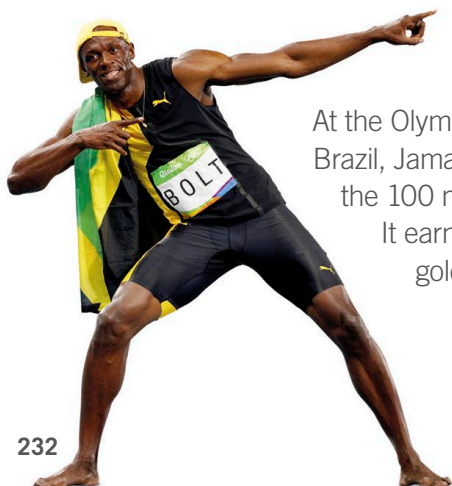
2019 Plastic raindrops

Scientists reported that they had found tiny plastic particles called microplastics in rainfall in Boulder, Colorado, USA. Less than 5 mm (0.2 in) in size, microplastics are harmful to humans and animals if eaten.



Born this day

1959 Earvin "Magic" Johnson, Black American basketball player. During his 13-year career, he played for the Los Angeles Lakers, and won gold at the 1992 Olympic Games.



Golden sprint 2016

At the Olympic Games in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, Jamaican sprinter Usain Bolt won the 100 m event in just 9.81 seconds. It earned him his third consecutive gold medal for the 100 m sprint after wins at the 2008 and 2012 Olympics.

Also on this day

1281 While invading Japan, Mongol forces led by Kublai Khan faced a typhoon at sea, losing most of their ships. The Japanese believed that the invading fleet was destroyed by divine winds, or *kamikaze*.

1945 Japan surrendered to the Allied forces, ending World War II, following the US bombings of the cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki.